

STEPH SIMMONS

PLATFORM ENGINEER · AWS SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT

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PROFILE

Associate with 10+ years in enterprise IT and 5+ years independently designing, building, and deploying cloud-native systems. Combines hands-on infrastructure automation, Infrastructure as Code, CI/CD, containers, observability, identity and access, and API engineering with enterprise experience in incident escalation, release readiness, supportability, and cross-team platform change. Brings a systems view of dependencies across application and infrastructure layers and builds solutions designed to remain reliable and operable after launch.

PLATFORM ENGINEERING SKILLS

INFRASTRUCTURE AUTOMATION AWS CDK · Terraform · GitHub Actions CI/CD · OIDC · Python · REST APIs

CLOUD + CONTAINERS AWS Lambda · ECS Fargate · API Gateway · EventBridge · SQS · DynamoDB · S3 · CloudFront · CloudWatch · IAM · Docker

PLATFORM ARCHITECTURE Event-driven architecture · Serverless · Container workloads · Multi-tenant architecture · Identity & access · Observability

OPERATIONAL ENGINEERING Technical escalation · Incident analysis · Release readiness · Supportability · Documentation · Cross-team troubleshooting

PLATFORM ENGINEERING PROJECTS

01 RABBITHOLE INDEPENDENT PROJECT

- Designed and implemented an event-driven AWS video-processing architecture using ECS Fargate, EventBridge, SQS, Lambda, CloudFront, and CloudWatch, decoupling API traffic from asynchronous compute and scaling workers to zero between jobs.
- Provisioned infrastructure with Terraform and built GitHub Actions delivery using OIDC-assumed IAM roles, eliminating static AWS deployment credentials.
- Engineered containerized ffmpeg processing with SQS/DLQ failure handling, workload-aware autoscaling, CloudWatch dashboards, and distributed job-status visibility.

02 QUICLENS CO-FOUNDER · CLOUD ENGINEER

- Re-platformed a multi-tenant scientific analytics platform from Vercel/Railway to AWS-native delivery using AWS CDK v2, container-image Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, S3/CloudFront, and WorkOS identity.
- Enforced tenant-aware access through verified WorkOS identity, organization/lab membership checks, role-based authorization, and resource-level controls for cross-lab sharing.
- Developed 143 backend pytest test functions across 9 modules covering API integration, upload validation, parsing, classification, curve fitting, thresholds, and SD50/Reed-Muench math; packaged NumPy, pandas, and SciPy workloads in x86_64 Lambda containers.

03 PUREZEN INFRASTRUCTURE MODERNIZATION

- Re-platformed PureZen across three infrastructure generations: an AWS Academy three-tier environment (EC2, ALB, VPC/subnets, routing, IAM), Vercel/Hetzner, and a serverless AWS architecture using Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, S3/CloudFront, and CDK v2.
- Adapted FastAPI to Lambda with Mangum and replaced self-hosted Ollama with managed Anthropic inference, reducing persistent compute and runtime dependencies while preserving deterministic booking workflows.

EXPERIENCE

INDEPENDENT ENGINEER · CLOUD & PRODUCT DESIGN

2021-PRESENT

RABBITHOLE · QUICLENs · PUREZEN

- Design and ship deployed cloud systems end-to-end in isolated AWS environments using Infrastructure as Code, automated delivery, APIs, and container/serverless services.
- Apply enterprise-grade operational readiness across observability, documentation, supportability, security boundaries, and clean handoff.
- Diagnose architecture, runtime, dependency, and performance issues and rework implementations when platform constraints require a more reliable operating model.

IS SUPERVISOR · SCRUM MASTER

2025-PRESENT

MUTUAL OF OMAHA · OMAHA, NE

- Lead Enterprise IT service desk and serve as a technical escalation point for platform and infrastructure issues spanning engineering, infrastructure, identity, and security.
- Analyze incident and support telemetry to surface systemic issues and improve operational readiness, troubleshooting quality, and knowledge standards.
- Coordinate across technical teams during high-impact incidents and platform changes, translating engineering context into clear operational action.

TECHNICAL LEAD · SCRUM MASTER

2022-2025

MUTUAL OF OMAHA · OMAHA, NE

- Owned technical intake, dependency management, and release readiness across engineering and infrastructure teams.
- Coordinated major platform changes between engineering and service operations, translating implementation dependencies into rollout and support readiness.
- Built KPI dashboards for delivery trends, capacity, and risk used by leadership.

BUSINESS SYSTEMS CONSULTANT · SCRUM MASTER

2019-2022

MUTUAL OF OMAHA · OMAHA, NE

- Translated business requirements into detailed technical stories across multi-team delivery streams and partnered with security and data teams on compliance and integration requirements.

SENIOR SERVICE DESK ANALYST

2015-2019

MUTUAL OF OMAHA · OMAHA, NE

- Provided advanced troubleshooting across applications, platforms, and infrastructure in a high-volume enterprise environment.
- Authored knowledge content that improved engineering-ticket quality and reduced rework; led onboarding and training.

EDUCATION + CERTIFICATION

AWS CERTIFIED SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT - ASSOCIATE

AMAZON WEB SERVICES · 2026

MS, MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEMS + MBA (DUAL)

UNIVERSITY OF NEBRASKA - OMAHA · 2024-PRESENT

BS, MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEMS

UNIVERSITY OF NEBRASKA - OMAHA · 2020-2023

SYSTEMS DEVELOPMENT CERTIFICATION

UNIVERSITY OF NEBRASKA - OMAHA · 2023